

Communicating With Loved Ones After a Disaster

If Seattle experiences a strong earthquake or other significant event, everyone will be on their phones trying to communicate. Circuits will be overloaded. It's also likely that cell phone towers will be damaged and power will go down.



Reaching loved ones could be very difficult.

Communicating after a disaster:

1. **Text** your household members after a large disaster; it's more likely a text will get thru than a phone call.
2. It's sometimes easier to get a text out of the city than across the city. Designate a trusted person who lives east of Spokane, WA, to be your Out-Of-Area Contact (OOAC). (Avoid those along the west coast; you don't want them involved in the same disaster.)
3. When you text household members, include your OOAC on the group text.
4. If it looks like household members aren't receiving texts, your OOAC can try forwarding your text to household members in the disaster zone.
6. They can also contact loved ones directly after they've heard from you – and post your status on social media.

PLEASE COMPLETE:

1. Write down the phone number for your household's OOAC – along with other important phone numbers – so you have them in case your phone is damaged and you are able to borrow a phone.
2. Write down your OOAC's email address. The Hub network and Ham radio operators might be able to help you email them using amateur radio frequencies.



[Emergency Communication Hubs](#)

Neighbors Helping Neighbors